

Given the rapid pace of technological development and the monthly releases of newer personal computing devices, the rate at which people upgrade computers is rapidly increasing. With nearly 500 million units of computer devices like laptops, desktops, netbooks and ultrabooks being sold every year the amount of technology that is discarded in the name of upgrades is tremendous. In America alone over 100,000 computers are discarded everyday. In most cases the reason behind such trashing is the inability of the hardware to keep up with software developments in operating system usage and gaming.

But in the age of cloud computing the appliance model behind Chrome OS has gone a long way to making us question the need for frequent upgrades. It is true that persons in specialised fields will continue to upgrade their hardware to keep up with their basic requirements, but casual users who use computers for emailing, media viewing, surfing the net and working on office suites, don't have to discard their old machines just because the latest version of their office suite slows the system down. And if you have any old systems still creaking away you can breathe new life into them and see the surprising rejuvenation that the Chrome OS can bring to their functionality.

Revitalising Old Devices

A key reason to consider using an older or obsolete machine for your first Chromebook has to do with intent of use and cost savings. Even if you wish to invest in a very low end computing device like a 20,000 rupees netbook, you know that it will come with added deferred expenses in the form of a fully featured antivirus or office suite. In addition to which it will most likely lack an optical drive and have very limited onboard storage. But if you have an outdated machine (even five or ten years old) which still has its storage, RAM and processor intact you are set to have a wonderful Chrome OS experience which will allow you access to cloud apps that can accomplish most everyday tasks.



Making the most out of old devices is a skill that's useful